



TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY OF DENMARK

Exercise 5

Expectation-maximization algorithm

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Introduction

Segmentation of medical images is important for both the individual patient, e.g., diagnosis and treatment plan, and for group studies, e.g., drug trials.

To do this the generative model can be used. It tries to describe how an image could be generated. In other words we simulate the imaging process. The generative model can be divided into two parts:

- Labeling model
- Imaging model

The **labeling model** describes where different anatomical structures would appear in the image. In this model, each voxel is assigned a label, and these labels are represented by a probability distribution $p(l|\theta_l)$, where l describes a vectorized label image, and θ_l are specific parameters that are known or need to be estimated. The probability function describes how likely specific structures would appear in specific places.

The **imaging model** describes what image intensities we would expect to see, given the labels. It is written as $p(d|l, \theta_d)$, where d is the observed intensity image and θ_d are the parameters given or estimated.

By using Bayes' rule, we can compute the posterior probability of how likely is each possible label configuration:

$$p(l | d, \hat{\theta}) = \frac{p(d | l, \hat{\theta}_d) p(l | \hat{\theta}_l)}{p(d | \hat{\theta})} \quad (1)$$

One example of a simple generative model is the **Gaussian-Mixture Model** (GMM). This model assumes that our data comes from a mixture of different Gaussian distributions. So this means it assumes that each tissue or structure can be represented with an individual gaussian distribution. So each label k has:

- Mean intensity μ_k
- Variance σ_k^2

- Probability of appearing (mixing weight) π_k

In the GMM the labeling model describes that each voxel belongs to the tissue type k with probability π_k . Here the voxels do not depend on each other, meaning there is no spatial relationship.

$$p(l | \theta_l) = \prod_{n=1}^N p(l_n | \theta_l) \quad (2)$$

The imaging model describes that given a voxel n label, its intensity will follow a Gaussian distribution, meaning its intensity will be near the mean μ_k with a variability σ_k^2 .

$$p(d_n | l_n = k, \theta_d) = \mathcal{N}(d_n | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \quad (3)$$

In the GMM parameters $\theta = \{\mu_k, \sigma_k^2, \pi_k\}$ can be manually picked, but this is not practical in MRI as if you keep the segmentation parameters fixed for the T1 image they wouldn't work on a T2 image, as the intensity values vary. To estimate the parameters automatically we look for the parameters that maximize the likelihood function $p(d|\theta)$, that describes the probability of the image d for the different settings of the parameter θ . For simplifying the math and easier computation we use the log-likelihood:

$$\hat{\theta} = \arg \max_{\theta} \log p(d | \theta) \quad (4)$$

To make the optimization easier the Expectation-Maximization (EM) algorithm is used. This builds and maximizes a simpler lower bound function $Q(\theta|\tilde{\theta})$ of the log-likelihood, step by step. The lower bound is simpler and easier to maximize, and it will touch the real log-likelihood at the current parameter estimate, and stay below everywhere else. So when we maximize $Q(\theta|\tilde{\theta})$ we are guaranteed to move in the direction that increases the real log-likelihood. The lower bound can be described as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_n \left[\sum_k w_k^n \log \left(\frac{\mathcal{N}(d_n | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \pi_k}{w_k^n} \right) \right] &= -\frac{1}{2} \sum_k \left[\frac{1}{\sigma_k^2} \sum_n w_k^n (d_n - \mu_k)^2 + \left(\sum_n w_k^n \right) \log \sigma_k^2 \right] \\ &\quad + \sum_k \left[\left(\sum_n w_k^n \right) \log \pi_k \right] + C \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

The EM-algorithm is divided into two steps: E-Step and M-step. The E-step is the expectation step, where we look how likely given the current parameters that voxel n belongs to class k .

$$\omega_{n,k} = \frac{\pi_k \mathcal{N}(d_n | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2)}{\sum_{k'} \pi_{k'} \mathcal{N}(d_n | \mu_{k'}, \sigma_{k'}^2)} \quad (6)$$

In the M-step we update the model parameters using the weights obtained in the E-step.

$$\begin{aligned}\mu_k &= \frac{\sum_n \omega_{n,k} d_n}{\sum_n \omega_{n,k}} \\ \sigma_k^2 &= \frac{\sum_n \omega_{n,k} (d_n - \mu_k)^2}{\sum_n \omega_{n,k}} \\ \pi_k &= \frac{\sum_n \omega_{n,k}}{N}\end{aligned}\tag{7}$$

In task 1-4 we are initializing the GMM, and from task 5-8 we optimize the parameters using the lower bound.

Disclaimer: Parts of the coding, troubleshooting, and text refinement were assisted by using AI tools (ChatGPT). The use of AI tools in this work was conducted in accordance with DTU's Honor Code and the regulations on academic integrity. All analysis, interpretations, and conclusions are the authors' own.

1 Task 1: Image data

Display the image provided in "correctedData.mat" and plot its histogram.

Hints:

- .mat data can be loaded in python as follows.

```
mat = loadmat("correctedData.mat")  
data = mat["correctedData"]
```
- Use 100 bins for your histogram
- The mask sets all background pixels to zero. Disregard the background pixels by clipping 0.

Looking at the histogram in figure 1 we can see that we have many background pixels with intensity 0. When looking at the zoomed histogram, we can observe how we have three "bumps". This corresponds to the three main tissue types in the image: Gray matter, White matter, and CSF.

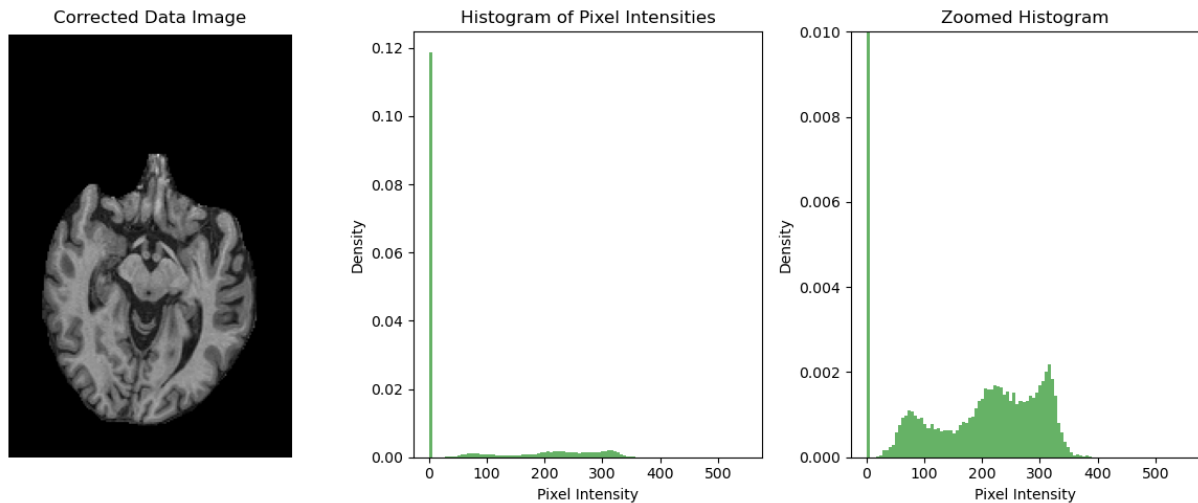


Figure 1: Visualization of the image provided in "correctedData.mat" and of the corresponding histogram.

2 Task 2: Initialize Gaussian-Mixture Model

Compute the minimum and maximum intensity in the image (non-zero pixels), and divide the intensity range up into three equally wide intervals. Initialize the parameters of a 3-component Gaussian mixture model by setting the means of the Gaussians to the centers of the intensity intervals, the variances to the square of the width of the intervals, and the prior weights to $\frac{1}{3}$ each.

Hint:

- In your intensity range, disregard the background pixels by clipping 0

The dataset only containing non-zero values were created in Task 1. The robust maximum is used with the 99 percentile to remove the extreme outliers. The intensities are split in three equal sizes and the mean of each interval is found. The variance is the width of the interval and will therefore be the same.

Robust max	Minimum	Means	Variances	Weights
		71.83		
345.59	17.07	181.34	109.50	0.33
		290.84		

Table 1: Overview of the initial values for the Gaussian Mixture model, the variances and weights are the the same for all three intervals.

2.1 Implementation of the code

```

1 data_f = data.copy()
2 data_f= data_f[data_f > 0]
3 max_rm = np.nanpercentile(data_f, 99)
4 min = np.nanmin(data_f)
5
6 interval_width = (max_rm - min) / 3
7
8 mu = np.array([min + interval_width/2, min + 3*interval_width/2, min +
   ↪ 5*interval_width/2])
9 sigma = np.array([interval_width, interval_width, interval_width])
10 pi = np.array([0.33, 0.33, 0.33])

```

3 Task 3: Display initial Gaussian distributions

Overlay the resulting Gaussian mixture model on the histogram by plotting each Gaussian weighted by its π_k , as well as the total weighted sum of all three Gaussian distributions (as in fig. 3.1(b) in the course notes).

Hint:

- A gaussian distribution with the parameters μ , σ^2 , scaled by the weight w and evaluated at positions x can be obtained by the function

$$w * \text{scipy.stats.norm.pdf}(x, \mu, \sigma)$$
- you can use the bin edges of your histogram as x .

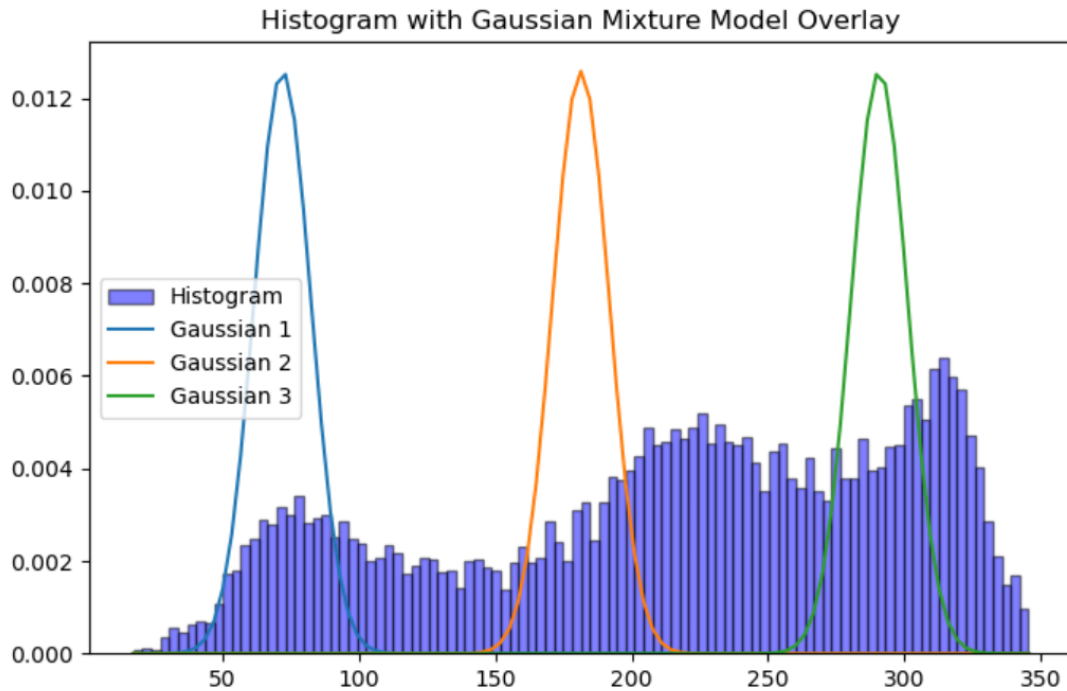


Figure 2: Histogram of the non-zero brain intensities with the three initialized Gaussian components overlaid. Each curve corresponds to one of the Gaussian distributions defined in Task 2, scaled by its mixing weight π_k

The Gaussian distribution is implemented using the function `scipy.stats.norm.pdf(data,  $\mu$ ,  $\sigma$ )`, where we use the mean, and standard deviation determined in Task 2. Figure 2 shows the Gaussian distribution plotted together with the intensity histograms. We observe, that the three Gaussian components are centered in different parts of the intensity range. They roughly follow the three visible modes of the histogram. These modes correspond to low-, medium-, and high-intensity tissue classes in the brain. So it indicates, that the initial parameter estimates from the previous task (Task 2), gives a reasonable starting point for the subsequent EM optimization.

3.1 Implementation of the code

```

1
2 hist, bin_edges = np.histogram(data_f, bins=100, range=(min, max_rm),
3                               ↪ density=True)
4 bin_centers = (bin_edges[:-1] + bin_edges[1:]) / 2
5 plt.figure(figsize=(8, 5))

```



```

6 plt.hist(data_f, bins=100, range=(min, max_rm), color='blue',
  ↪ edgecolor='black', alpha=0.5, density=True, label='Histogram')
7
8 gmm_sum = np.zeros_like(bin_edges)
9 for k in range(3):
10     gaussian = pi[k] * norm.pdf(bin_edges, mu[k], np.sqrt(sigma[k]))
11     plt.plot(bin_edges, gaussian, label=f'Gaussian {k+1}')
12     gmm_sum += gaussian
13
14 plt.legend()
15 plt.title('Histogram with Gaussian Mixture Model Overlay')
16 plt.show()

```

4 Task 4: Compute weights

Compute the values of $w_{n,k}$ defined by:

$$w_{n,k} = \frac{\mathcal{N}(d_n | \tilde{\mu}_k, \tilde{\sigma}_k^2) \tilde{\pi}_k}{\sum_{k'=1}^K \mathcal{N}(d_n | \tilde{\mu}'_{k'}, \tilde{\sigma}_{k'}^2) \tilde{\pi}'_{k'}}.$$

Visualize the values of each $w_{n,k}$ in a figure. You should have three plots which each display only the pixels that belong to the respective class, according to the weights.

Hint:

- The segmentation of a pixel is determined by assigning the class of the highest probability.
- In your visualization, disregard the background pixels by clipping 0

The weights are computed according to equation 6, where the numerator $\pi_k \mathcal{N}(d_n | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2)$ represent the likelihood of the observed intensity value d_n under class k , weighted by the prior π_k . The denominator is the sum of these weighted likelihoods over all classes and ensures that the weights form a proper probability distribution.

The values $w_{n,k}$ tell us how likely it is that that pixel n belongs to class k . To visualize the

result, we simply assign each pixel to the class with the highest weight, and show three separate images, one for each class, see Figure 3. Each figure only displays the pixels that are most likely to belong to that class. Background pixels are removed using the brain mask, so that only the relevant regions are shown.

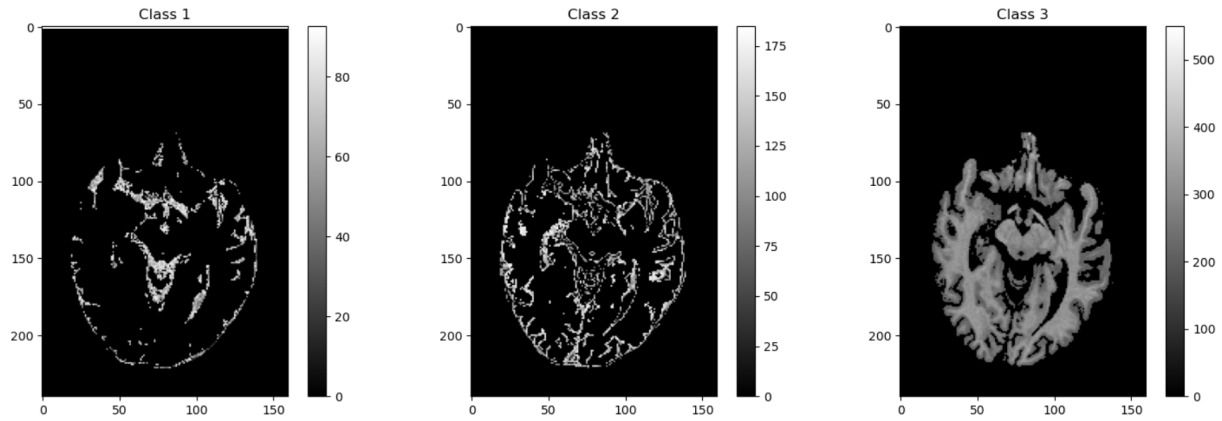


Figure 3: Hard segmentation obtained by assigning each pixel to the class with the highest weight $w_{n,k}$. Each subplot displays only the pixels belonging to one of the three classes, restricted to the brain mask.

4.1 Implementation of the code

```

1     K = 3
2     print(data.shape)
3     H, W = data.shape
4     likelihoods = np.zeros((H, W, K))
5     for k in range(K):
6         likelihoods[:, :, k] = norm.pdf(data, loc=mu[k], scale=sigma[k])
7     numerator = likelihoods * pi
8     denominator = np.sum(numerator, axis=2, keepdims=True)
9     w = np.divide(numerator, denominator, out = np.zeros_like(numerator),
10                  ↪ where=denominator!=0)
11
12     plt.figure(figsize=(15, 5))
13
14     for k in range(K):
15         plt.subplot(1, 3, k+1)
16         # Argmax to find the pixel with the maximum prob for that k class
17         mask = np.argmax(w, axis=2) == k
18         img = np.where(mask, data, 0)
19         plt.imshow(img, cmap='gray')
20         plt.title(f'Class {k+1}')

```

```

20 plt.colorbar()
21
22 plt.tight_layout()
23 plt.show()

```

5 Task 5: Estimate Maximum Likelihood parameters

Estimate the maximum likelihood parameters by iterating between updating the model parameter estimate according to

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{\mu}_k &\leftarrow \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k} d_n}{\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k}} \\ \tilde{\sigma}_k^2 &\leftarrow \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k} (d_n - \tilde{\mu}_k)^2}{\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k}} \\ \tilde{\pi}_k &\leftarrow \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k}}{N}\end{aligned}$$

and by recomputing $w_{n,k}$ according to eq. 3.33 (see Task 4).

Make sure to perform enough iterations (e.g., 100) for the algorithm to converge. As the iterations progress, plot the evolution of the log likelihood function, and update each time the display of $w_{n,k}$ as well as the Gaussian mixture model plot overlaid on the histogram. Include the evolution of the log likelihood function and the plot of the final $w_{n,k}$ and the final mixture model in your report.

Hint:

- The log likelihood can be simply computed by $\log(\sum_k w_k x_k)$

To estimate the maximum likelihood parameters of the Gaussian mixture model, we implemented the expectation-maximization (EM) algorithm in a small GMM class (see Appendix). The algorithm alternates between:

- **E-step:** given the current parameters $(\mu_k, \sigma_k^2, \pi_k)$, we compute the responsibilities $w_{n,k}$

using the numerically stable log-sum-exp formulation.

- **M-step:** we update the means, variances and mixing weights using the weighted formulas in the task description, based only on the non-zero (brain) voxels.

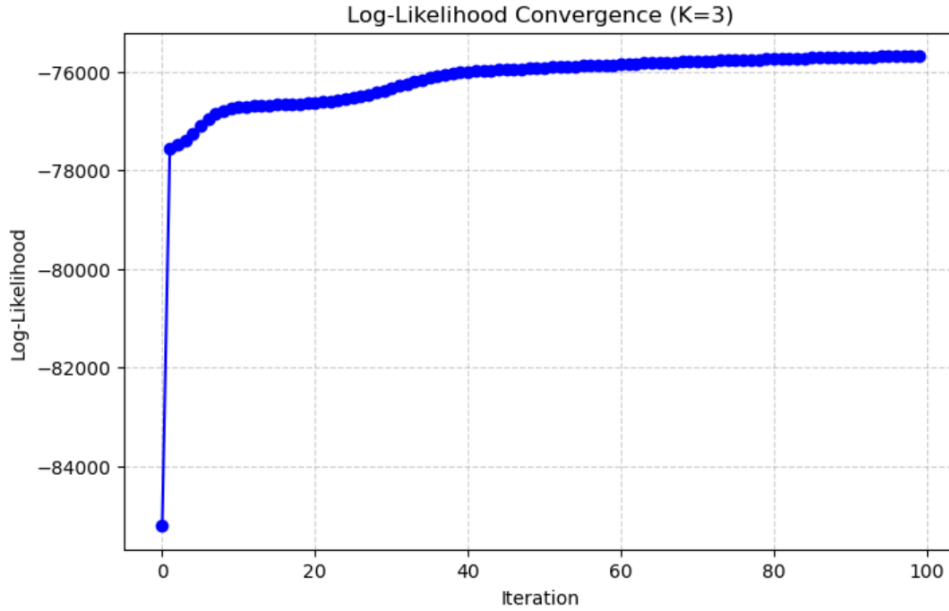


Figure 4: Evolution of the log-likelihood over EM iterations. The curve increases monotonically and plateaus after a number of iterations, indicating convergence of the parameter estimates.

We initialize the parameters from the masked data, and run EM for 100 iteration. During the fitting we store the log-likelihood in each of the iterations using only in-mask voxels. Figure 4 shows that the log-likelihood increases monotonically and quickly levels off. This indicates that the algorithm has converged to a stable solution.

After convergence, the three Gaussian components have separated mean intensities, covering low, medium and high intensity ranges that match the expected CSF, gray matter and white matter tissue classes.

Using the final responsibilities $w_{n,k}$, we compute a hard segmentation by assigning each of the voxels to the class with the highest posterior probability. The resulting segmentation maps for the three tissues classes are shown in Figure 5. Compared to the initial segmentation from

Task 4, we can observe how the different tissue types are weighted differently, and more in accordance to the histogram intensity distribution. There are three distinct areas, that matches GM, WM and CSF.

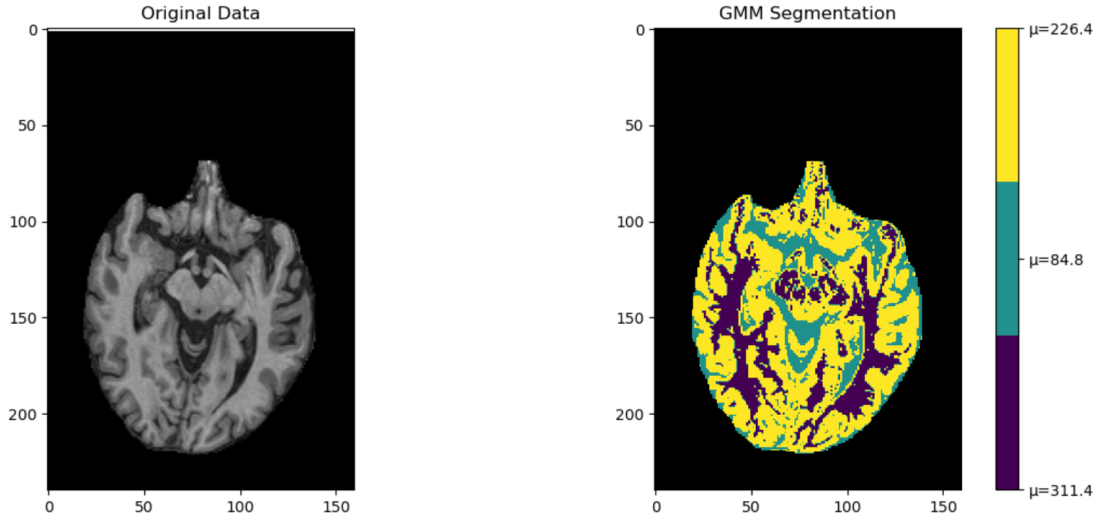


Figure 5: Final hard segmentation obtained from the converged responsibilities $w_{n,k}$. The left panel shows the original bias-corrected MR slice, and the right panel shows the final GMM-based segmentation. Each colour corresponds to one of the three tissue classes, with the colourbar indicating the class means μ_k in intensity units. Voxels outside the brain mask are shown in black.

Finally, we overlay the converged Gaussian mixture model on the intensity histogram in Figure 6. Each component is scaled by its mixing weight π_k , and the sum of all three components follows the histogram much more closely than in Task 3. This confirms that the EM algorithm has adapted the model parameters to better fit the observed intensity distribution.

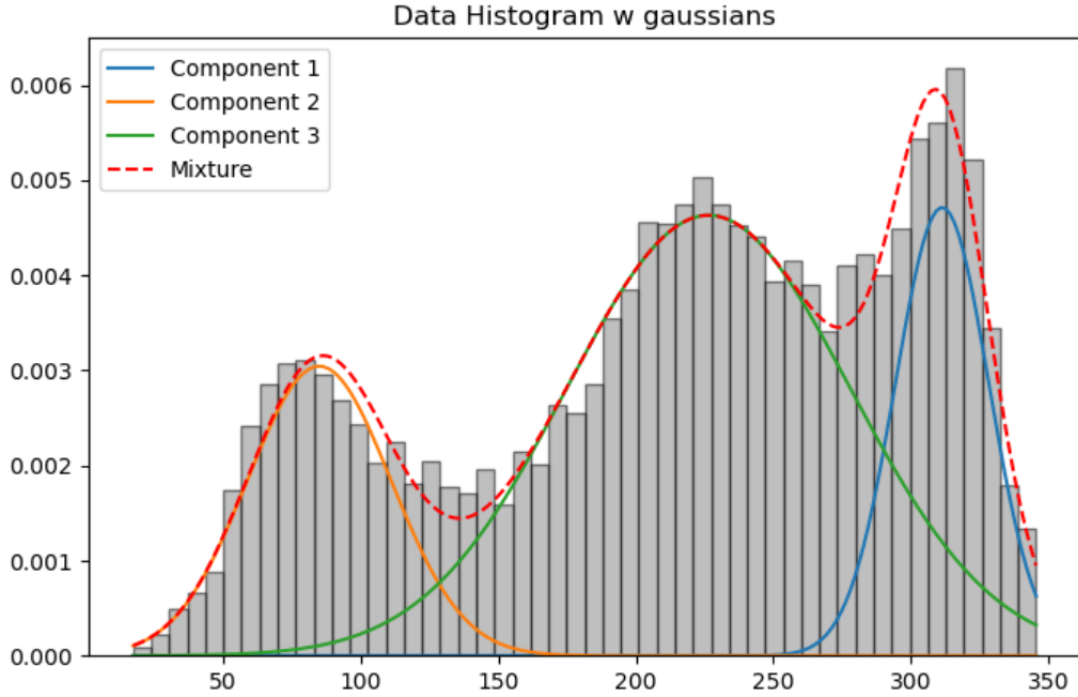


Figure 6: Corrected intensity histogram with the final Gaussian mixture model overlaid. The three weighted Gaussian components and their sum provide a good approximation of the empirical intensity distribution.

6 Task 6: Vary only one model parameter

Keeping all other parameters fixed to their estimated values, vary only μ_2 (the mean of the middle Gaussian distribution) between the estimated values of μ_1 and μ_3 in about 100 steps, and plot for each step the log likelihood function.

To investigate how the log-likelihood behaves when we only change a single parameter, we sweep μ_2 - the mean of the middle Gaussian component - across an evenly spaced range between the estimated values of μ_1 and μ_3 obtained in Task 5. All other parameters μ_1 , μ_3 , σ_k , π_k are kept fixed.

For each value of μ_2 in this range, we then recompute the log-likelihood of the full GMM model. The resulting curve is shown in Figure 7. The log-likelihood is maximized precisely at the estimated value of μ_2 obtained by the EM algorithm. This shows, that the EM

estimate corresponds to the maximum-likelihood point along this dimension. Additionally, the log-likelihood decreases symmetrically as μ_2 is moved away from its optimum, which reflects that if we were to misplace the middle Gaussian mean results, we would get poorer modeling of the intensity distribution. When checking this, it confirms both the correctness of the EM implementation and the stability of the estimated parameters.

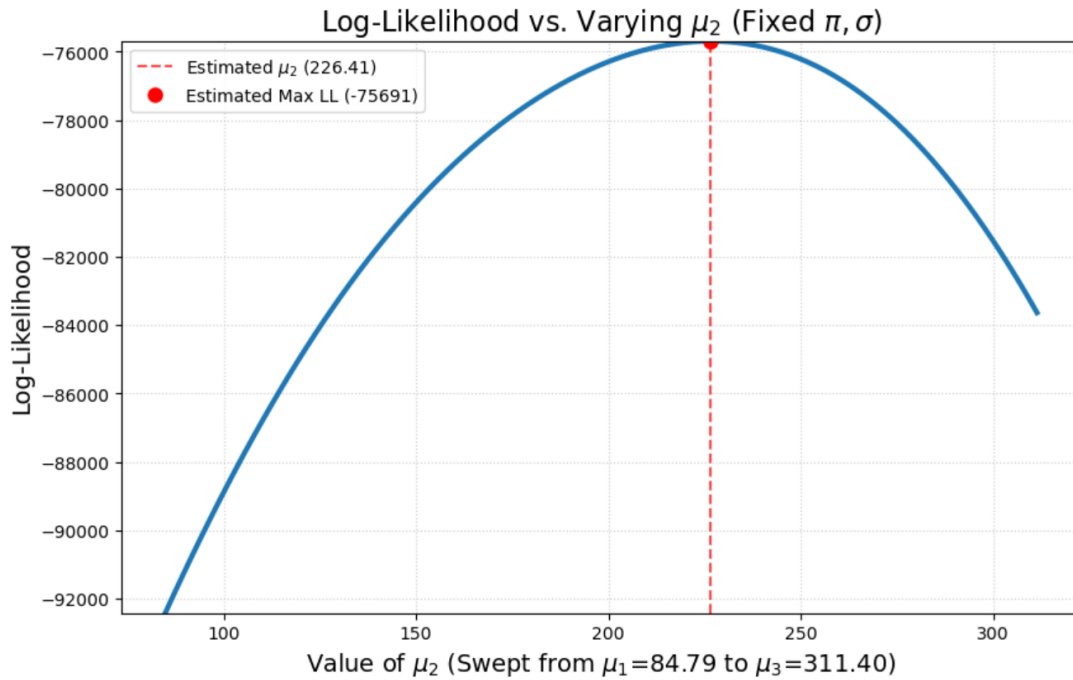


Figure 7: Log-likelihood as a function of μ_2 while keeping all other parameters fixed.

7 Task 7: Locate Lower bound

On the same figure, also plot the lower bound corresponding to the parameter vector in which all parameters are set to their estimated values, except μ_2 which is set to the estimated value of μ_1 .

The goal of the task is to calculate the values of the of Q-function, the EM algorithms' lower bound for at specific parameter setting. The setting θ^* is choosen, where all parameter are fixed to the final optimized values from Task 5, except for μ_2 , which is set equal to μ_1 . By manually calculating the Q-function, for different potential parameter values of μ_2 , the lower bound curve

can be visualized (green curve fig. 8).

By first setting $\mu_2 = \mu_1$ it is guaranteed that we are not at the optimal parameter value for μ_2 anymore, and hence, the Q curve should have a clear maximum. Figure 8, shows the Q function for different **potential** values of μ_2 , where μ_2 of the **model** was set to $\mu_2 = \mu_1$, from an already converged GMM ($w_{n,k}$ for the converged GMM were recalculated (E-step)). The curve shows how the M-step can choose the optimal new value of μ_2 by maximizing the lower bound given the fixed parameters, and only varying μ_2 .

```
1  def calculate_elbo_curve(gmm, data, w_frozen, mu_space, mu2_idx):
2      """
3      Calculates the full ELBO curve for the sweep, using the frozen
4      ↪ weights.
5      ELBO( $\theta$ ) =  $\sum_n \sum_k w_{nk} [ \log(\pi_k) + \log(N(x|\mu_k, \sigma_k)) - \log(w_{nk}) ]$ 
6      """
7
8      # Get parameters from the converged GMM
9      pi_hat = gmm.pi
10     mu_hat = gmm.mu
11     sigma_hat = gmm.sigma
12     eps = gmm.eps
13
14     flat_data_pos = data[data > 0]
15     w_frozen_pos = w_frozen[data > 0]
16
17     elbo_values = [] # store lb values
18     q_values = [] # store q values
19
20     for mu2_star in mu_space:
21
22         # copy mu and replace mu2 with the swept value
23         mu_try = mu_hat.copy()
24         mu_try[mu2_idx] = mu2_star
25
26         step_elbo = 0.0
27         step_q = 0.0
28
29         for k in range(gmm.k):
30             # E_w[log  $\pi_k$ ] ->
31             log_pi_k = np.log(pi_hat[k] + eps)
32
33             # E_w[log N(x| $\mu_k, \sigma_k$ )]
34             log_pdf = norm.logpdf(flat_data_pos,
```



```

34         loc=mu_try[k],
35         scale=np.sqrt(sigma_hat[k]))
36
37     # E_w[log w_nk]
38     log_w_k = np.log(w_frozen_pos[:, k] + eps)
39
40     # Combine: w * (log(pi) + log(N) - log(w))
41     term_k_elbo = w_frozen_pos[:, k] * (log_pi_k + log_pdf -
42     ↪ log_w_k) # -> elbo
43
44     step_elbo += np.sum(term_k_elbo)
45
46     elbo_values.append(step_elbo)
47     return elbo_values, q_values
48
49 def get_frozen_weights(gmm, data, mu_tilde):
50     """
51     Temporarily sets gmm.mu to mu_tilde, runs the E-step to get the
52     frozen responsibilities, and then restores the original gmm.mu.
53     """
54     # 1. Store the original, converged mu_hat
55     mu_original = gmm.mu.copy()
56
57     try:
58         gmm.mu = mu_tilde
59         w_frozen, _ = gmm.e_step(data)
60
61     finally:
62         gmm.mu = mu_original
63
64     return w_frozen

```

8 Task 8: Maximize lower bound

Compute the value for μ_2 that maximizes this lower bound (first line of eq. 3.35), indicate its location on the figure, and comment on the result.

Formulate the lower bound as

$$\begin{aligned}
Q(\theta|\tilde{\theta}) = & -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=1}^K \left[\frac{1}{\sigma_k^2} \sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k} (d_n - \mu_k - \sum_{m=1}^M c_m \phi_{n,m})^2 + \left(\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k} \right) \log \sigma_k^2 \right] \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^K \left[\left(\sum_{n=1}^N w_{n,k} \right) \log \pi_k \right] \\
& - \sum_{n=1}^N \sum_{k=1}^K w_{n,k} \log w_{n,k} - \frac{N}{2} \log(2\pi)
\end{aligned}$$

The maximum lower bound is calculated and plotted in this task. This task helps in understanding the expectation-maximizing algorithm, specifically, how parameter updates are estimated and why it is robust to local maxima when $\mu_2 = \mu_1$, wrt. convergence properties. In figure 7, the log-likelihood function of varying μ_2 is displayed. There is a clear maximum, but the purpose is to show how the algorithm finds this maximum from the initial conditions and converges to the local maximum. The EM expectation step computes the weight given current parameters $\tilde{\theta}$, the maximization step finds the new parameter $\log \mathbf{p}(\mathbf{d}|\tilde{\theta})$ that maximize the Q-function, the lower bound plot in task 7, by closed form differentiation. Because the M-step maximizes the lower bound, the weight and parameter updates $\log \mathbf{p}(\mathbf{d}|\hat{\theta})$ for the next iteration of log-likelihood will be greater or equal to the previous.

The EM algorithm is designed to ensure an "up-hill" climbs toward local maximum and cannot convergence on local minima.

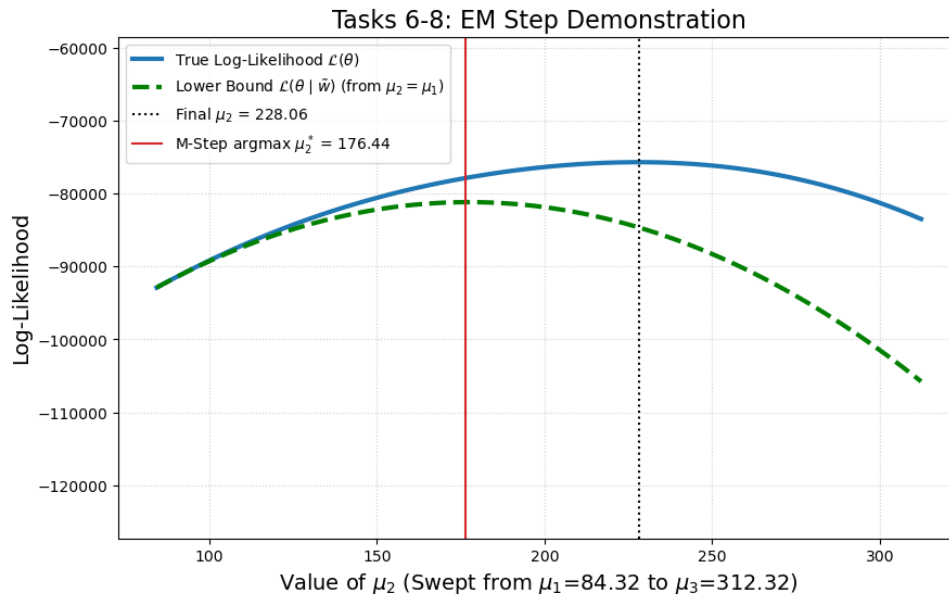


Figure 8: Lower Bound

```

1  # task 7: what is the maximization of the m_step? It is the maximization
   ↳ of the ELBO/q-function with frozen weights where mu_2 = mu_1
2  sorted_indices = np.argsort(gmm.mu)
3  k_min_index = sorted_indices[0]
4  mu2_idx = sorted_indices[1] # The index of the middle mean
5
6  mu_tilde = gmm.mu.copy()
7  mu_tilde[mu2_idx] = gmm.mu[k_min_index] # set mu_2 = mu_1
8
9
10 # get frozen weights
11 w_frozen = get_frozen_weights(gmm, data, mu_tilde)
12
13 # task 7: calculate q function- and ELBO curve
14 elbo_values, q_values = calculate_elbo_curve(gmm, data, w_frozen,
   ↳ mu_space, mu2_idx)
15
16
17 # task 8: find maximum of q function and ELBO
18 i_star = int(np.argmax(elbo_values))
19 mu2_star = float(mu_space[i_star])
20
21 # Plotting Everything task 6-8
22 plt.figure(figsize=(10, 6))
23
24 # plot 1: true Log-Likelihood

```

```

25 plt.plot(mu_space, log_likelihoods, color='#1f77b4', linewidth=3,
26          label='True Log-Likelihood  $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$ ')
27
28 # plot 2: ELBO
29 plt.plot(mu_space, elbo_values, color='green', linestyle='--',
30          linewidth=3,
31          label='Lower Bound  $\mathcal{L}(\theta \mid \tilde{w})$  (from
32            $\mu_2 = \mu_1$ )')
33
34 # plot 4: optimal mu2
35 plt.axvline(mu2_esti, color='k', ls=':', label=f'Final  $\mu_2 =$ 
36           {mu2_esti:.2f}')
37
38 # plot 4: argmax of q function and ELBO
39 plt.axvline(mu2_star, color='tab:red', ls='-',
40 label=f'M-Step argmax  $\mu_2^* =$  {mu2_star:.2f}')
41
42 # dynamic y-limits
43 min_ll_sweep = np.min(log_likelihoods)
44 max_ll_sweep = np.max(log_likelihoods)
45 buffer = (max_ll_sweep - min_ll_sweep) * 2
46 plt.ylim(min_ll_sweep - buffer, max_ll_sweep + buffer/2)
47
48 plt.title('Tasks 6-8: EM Step Demonstration', fontsize=16)
49 plt.xlabel(f'Value of  $\mu_2$  (Swept from  $\mu_1 = \mu_{\min} = {mu_{\min}:.2f}$  to
50            $\mu_3 = {mu_{\max}:.2f}$ )', fontsize=14)
51 plt.ylabel('Log-Likelihood', fontsize=14)
52 plt.grid(True, linestyle=':', alpha=0.6)
53 plt.legend()
54 plt.show()
55
56 print(f"Lower bound maximized at  $\mu_2^* = {mu2_star:.4f}")$ 
```

Conclusion

During this exercise, we have learned how we can use a Gaussian Mixture Model for segmentation of medical images.

We have focused on how, going from an initial guess to applying the EM algorithm, demonstrating how the algorithm iteratively estimates the parameters needed for accurate

segmentation.

Finally, we also looked at the lower bound and maximization step in detail. We learned and visualized how the model learns the "best" parameters with the EM algorithm.

Overall, the tasks gave a practical and intuitive understanding of GMM-based segmentation and the mechanics of the EM algorithm.

9 Appendix A

```
1 import numpy.ma as ma
2 class GMM:
3     def __init__(self, n_iterations=100, k=3):
4         """
5         Initiate class
6         Defines imported variables
7
8         Parameter
9         -----
10        self:
11            object to store variables and functions
12
13        n_iterations:
14            Number of iteration before termination
15
16        k:
17            Number of class to estimate with gaussians
18
19        """
20        self.n_iter = n_iterations
21        self.k = k
22
23        self.mu = None
24        self.sigma = None
25        self.pi = None
26
27        self.log_likelihood_history = []
28        self.last_w = None
29        self.eps = 1e-12
30
31    def init_param(self, data):
32        """
33        Initiates parameters
34        Flatten data, pi, mu, sigma, min, max and max_rm of the data
35
36        Parameters
37        -----
38        Self
39
40        data:
41            Any HxW data
42        """
43
```

```

44     self.flat_data = data[data>0]
45     N = len(self.flat_data)
46
47     self.pi = np.ones(self.k)/self.k
48
49     sample = np.random.choice(N, self.k, replace=False)
50     self.mu = self.flat_data[sample]
51
52     init_var = np.var(self.flat_data)/self.k
53     self.sigma = np.ones(self.k) * init_var
54
55     self.min = np.min(self.flat_data)
56     self.max = np.max(self.flat_data)
57     self.max_rm = np.percentile(self.flat_data, 99)
58
59     def e_step(self, data):
60         """
61         Estiamation step. This step computes the likelihood to calculate
62         ↪ the weights w and finally computes the totel likelihood and
63         ↪ log likelihood
64
65         Parameters
66         -----
67
68         self
69
70         data
71
72         Returns
73         -----
74
75         w:
76             Computed weights
77
78         Log likelihood:
79             The total log likelihood of this step
80         """
81         H, W = data.shape
82         log_comp = np.zeros((self.k, H, W))
83
84         for k in range(self.k):
85             log_pdf = norm.logpdf(data, loc=self.mu[k],
86                                   ↪ scale=np.sqrt(self.sigma[k]))
87             log_comp[k, :, :] = np.log(self.pi[k] + self.eps) + log_pdf
88         m = np.max(log_comp, axis=0, keepdims=True) # shape (1, H, W)

```

```

85     log_sum_exp = m + np.log(np.sum(np.exp(log_comp - m), axis=0,
86     ↪ keepdims=True) + self.eps)
87
88     # w = exp( log(numerator) - log(denominator) )
89     w = np.exp(log_comp - log_sum_exp) # shape (K, H, W)
90     log_likelihood = np.sum(log_sum_exp[0, data > 0])
91     w = w.transpose(1, 2, 0) # from (K, H, W) to (H, W, K)
92
93     self.last_w = w
94     return w, float(log_likelihood)
95
96     def m_step(self, data, w):
97         """
98         Maximization step: updates the parameters mu, sigma, and pi.
99         """
100         flat_data_pos = data[data > 0]
101         w_pos = w[data > 0]
102         N_pos = len(flat_data_pos)
103
104         for k in range(self.k):
105             w_k = w_pos[:, k]
106             w_k_sum = np.sum(w_k)
107
108             if w_k_sum > 0:
109                 self.mu[k] = np.sum(w_k * flat_data_pos) / w_k_sum
110
111                 new_sigma = np.sum(w_k * (flat_data_pos - self.mu[k]) **
112                 ↪ 2) / w_k_sum
113                 self.sigma[k] = np.maximum(new_sigma, self.eps)
114
115                 self.pi[k] = w_k_sum / N_pos
116             else:
117                 self.pi[k] = 0.0
118
119         sum_pi = np.sum(self.pi)
120         if sum_pi > 0:
121             self.pi /= sum_pi
122         else:
123             self.pi = np.ones(self.k) / self.k
124
125     def fit(self, data):
126
127         self.init_param(data)
128
129         for i in range(self.n_iter):

```



```

128         w, log_likelihood = self.e_step(data)
129         self.log_likelihood_history.append(log_likelihood)
130         self.m_step(data, w)
131
132         return self
133
134 # ----- plotting functions
135 ↪ -----
136
137 def plot_convergence(self):
138     """Plots the log-likelihood history to show convergence."""
139     if not self.log_likelihood_history:
140         print("Model has not been fitted yet. Run .fit(data) first.")
141         return
142
143     plt.figure(figsize=(8, 5))
144     plt.plot(self.log_likelihood_history, marker='o', linestyle='-',
145             ↪ color='blue')
146     plt.title(f'Log-Likelihood Convergence (K={self.k})')
147     plt.xlabel('Iteration')
148     plt.ylabel('Log-Likelihood')
149     plt.grid(True, linestyle='--', alpha=0.6)
150     plt.show()
151
152 def plot_segmentation_components(gmm_model, data):
153     """
154     Plots the hard segmentation masks for each component (K=3).
155     """
156     # get segmentation
157     # shape (H, W) where each value is 0, 1, or 2
158     segmentation_map = np.argmax(gmm_model.last_w, axis=2)
159
160     background_mask = (data <= 0)
161
162     fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, gmm_model.k, figsize=(15, 5))
163
164     for k in range(gmm_model.k):
165         ax = axes[k]
166
167         # one if pixel belongs to component k
168         binary_mask = (segmentation_map == k)
169
170         # only show the segmented tissue (data > 0)
171         plot_data = ma.array(binary_mask.astype(int),
172             ↪ mask=background_mask)

```

```

170         cmap = plt.cm.gray.copy()
171         cmap.set_bad('black')
172
173         im = ax.imshow(plot_data, cmap=cmap, vmin=0, vmax=1)
174
175         mu_val = gmm_model.mu[k]
176         ax.set_title(f'Comp {k} Hard Mask:  $\mu$ ={mu_val:.2f}')
177         ax.axis('off')
178         ax.axis('off')
179
180     plt.tight_layout()
181     plt.show()
182
183     def plot_responsibilities(self, data):
184         if self.last_w is None:
185             print("Model has not been fitted yet. Run .fit(data) first.")
186             return
187
188         total = self.k + 1
189         ncols = 3 if total > 3 else (2 if total > 1 else 1)
190         nrows = int(np.ceil(total / ncols))
191
192         fig, axes = plt.subplots(nrows, ncols, figsize=(4 * ncols, 4 *
193             ↪ nrows))
194         axes = np.array(axes).flatten()
195
196         axes[0].imshow(data, cmap='gray')
197         axes[0].set_title('Original')
198         axes[0].axis('off')
199
200         mask = (data <= 0)
201         cmap = plt.cm.get_cmap('gray_r').copy()
202         cmap.set_bad('black')
203
204         for idx in range(self.k):
205             ax = axes[idx + 1]
206             im = ax.imshow(ma.array(self.last_w[:, :, idx], mask=mask),
207                 ↪ cmap=cmap, vmin=0, vmax=1)
208             ax.set_title(f'Comp {idx}:  $\mu$ ={self.mu[idx]:.2f},
209                 ↪  $\sigma$ ={self.sigma[idx]:.2f}')
210             ax.axis('off')
211             fig.colorbar(im, ax=ax, fraction=0.046, pad=0.04)
212
213         for ax in axes[total:]:
214             fig.delaxes(ax)

```

```

212     plt.tight_layout()
213     plt.show()
214
215
216     def plot_segmentation(self, data):
217         """
218         Plots the original image and GMM segmentation side-by-side.
219         """
220         if self.last_w is None:
221             print("Model has not been fitted yet. Run .fit(data) first.")
222             return
223
224         # Create side-by-side plots
225         fig, (ax1, ax2) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(12, 5))
226
227         # Plot original data
228         ax1.imshow(data, cmap='gray')
229         ax1.set_title('Original Data')
230
231         # Create segmentation map
232         seg_map = np.argmax(self.last_w, axis=2)
233         mask = (data <= 0)
234         masked_seg = ma.array(seg_map, mask=mask)
235
236         # Plot segmentation with meaningful colors
237         cmap = plt.cm.get_cmap('viridis', self.k)
238         cmap.set_bad(color='black')
239         im = ax2.imshow(masked_seg, cmap=cmap)
240         ax2.set_title('GMM Segmentation')
241
242         # Add colorbar with component info
243         cbar = plt.colorbar(im, ax=ax2)
244         cbar.set_ticks(range(self.k))
245         cbar.set_ticklabels([f' $\mu={self.mu[i]:.1f}$ ' for i in
246                               ↪ range(self.k)])
247
248         plt.tight_layout()
249         plt.show()
250
251     def plot_hist(self):
252         """Plots histogram of data with GMM component overlay"""
253         plt.figure(figsize=(8, 5))
254
255         # Plot histogram of data
256         plt.hist(self.flat_data, bins=50, range=(self.min, self.max_rm),

```

```

256         density=True, alpha=0.5, color='gray', edgecolor='black')
257
258     # Plot GMM components
259     x = np.linspace(self.min, self.max_rm, 200)
260     total = np.zeros_like(x)
261     for k in range(self.k):
262         component = self.pi[k] * norm.pdf(x, self.mu[k],
263             ↪ np.sqrt(self.sigma[k]))
264         plt.plot(x, component, label=f'Component {k+1}')
265         total += component
266
267     plt.plot(x, total, 'r--', label='Mixture')
268     plt.title('Data Histogram w gaussians')
269     plt.legend()
270     plt.show()

```